

A

Surrounded by nature

“I grew up in the **countryside** where I was **surrounded by**¹ nature. As children, we used to play on the **banks**² of the river and in the **woods**³. In the summer we **picked**⁴ apples and blackberries; in the autumn we often picked mushrooms. The **seasons**⁵ were all different, and I loved the **scenery**⁶, the **open spaces**⁷, and the **fresh air**⁸. I still do.”

¹ nature was everywhere around me

² the side of the river

³ groups of trees

⁴ took them from the tree/plant

⁵ spring, summer, autumn, winter

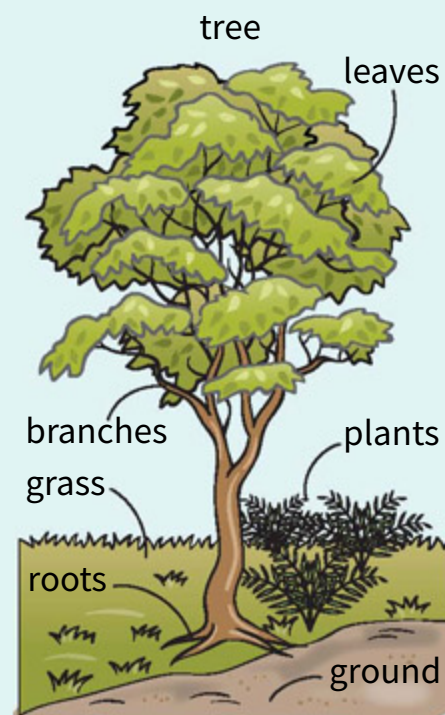
⁶ the natural beauty you see around you

⁷ empty areas of land

⁸ naturally clean air

Common mistakes

I like being **in the countryside**. OR I like being **surrounded by nature**. (NOT I like being ~~in the nature~~.)



B

Working in the country

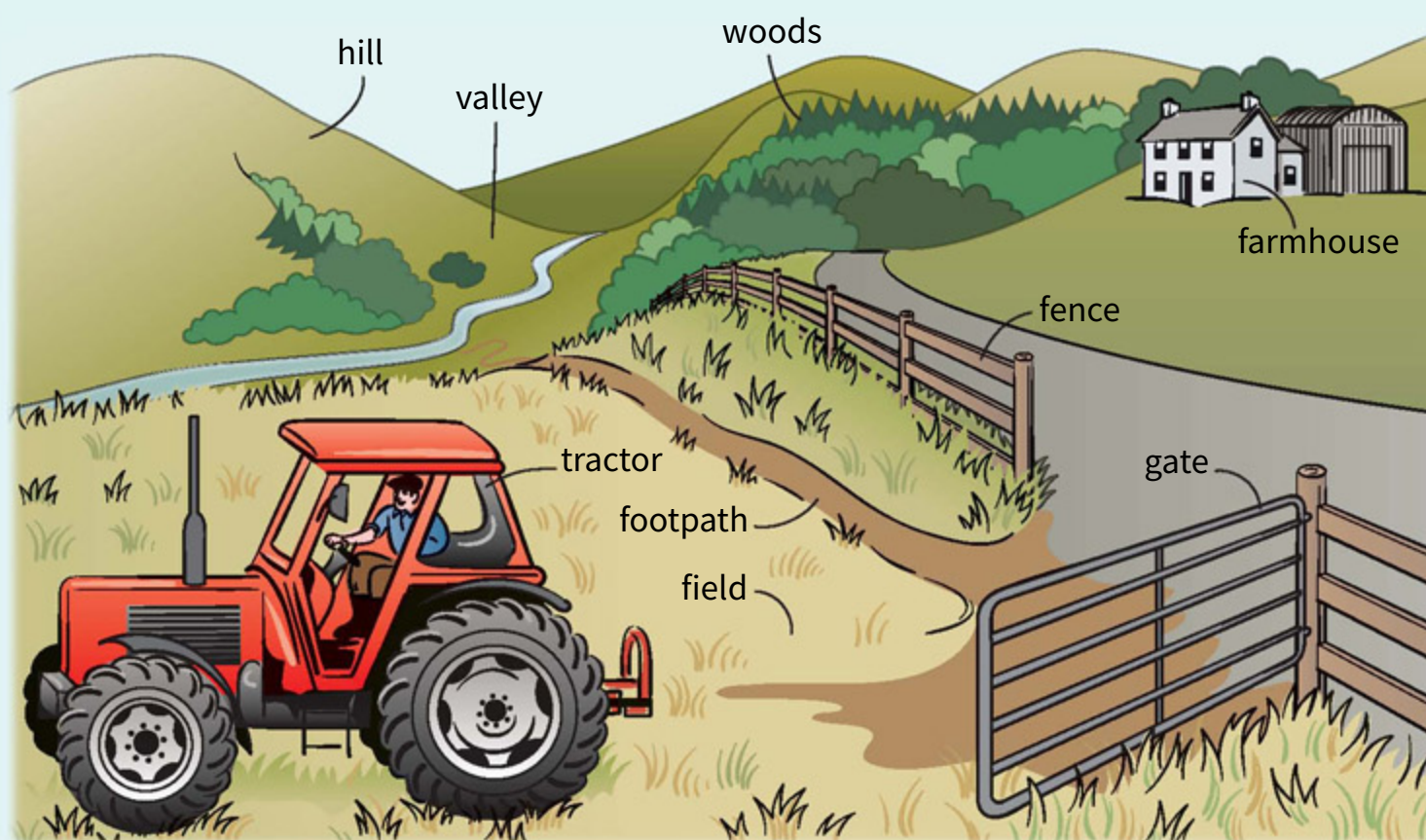
“My uncle **owns**¹ a farm. He **keeps**² a few animals, but mostly he grows **crops** like barley, wheat and potatoes. **Farming** is a hard life: my uncle is usually **up**³ at five in the morning, and sometimes his work isn't finished until **sunset**⁴.”

¹ has (something that legally belongs to him)

² owns and looks after them

³ not in bed

⁴ when the sun goes down in the evening



C

The disadvantages of country life

“The **worst thing about** living in a **village**¹ is that **there isn't much to do** in the evening, apart from going to the village pub. The nearest town is eight miles **away**², and **public transport**³ is **hopeless**⁴. And, of course, **you don't get**⁵ many shops in a village.”

¹ a place smaller than a town

² a distance from a place

³ buses and trains for people to use

⁴ terrible

⁵ there aren't / you don't find